

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 2

COURSE NAME: CSA07 **COURSE CODE:** Computer Networks

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO1: Apply the functions of OSI layer in enabling reliable data transmission across networks. (BL2, BL3)

Assessment Tool Weightage: 30%

Annexure A

CONCEPT MAPPING

1. A partially completed concept map is given below:

Application → Presentation → _____ → Transport → Network → _____ → Physical.

Analyze the missing layers and explain how their functions are essential for reliable communication.

2. Construct a concept map linking data units (Segment, Packet, Frame, Bits) with their respective OSI layers and analyze how transformation of data units supports transmission.

3. Given the concept map:

DataLink → MACAddress → LocalDelivery

Network → IP Address → Global Delivery

Explain how these relationships ensure complete data delivery across networks.

4. A concept map shows:

ErrorControl

→ DataLinkLayer → ErrorDetection

→ Transport Layer → Error Correction

Analyze how the interaction between these layers improves reliability in data transmission.

5. Develop a concept map for web browsing using OSI layers and analyze how failure in one layer affects the entire communication process.

6. A network issue is represented in the concept map:

Physical ✓ → Data Link ✓ → Network ✗ → Transport ✗ → Application ✗

Analyze the problem and explain how the concept map helps in troubleshooting.

RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION

Criteria	Weightage (%)	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (Proficient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Concept Identification	20%	Accurately identifies all relevant OSI layers, concepts, and relationships	Identifies most concepts with minor omissions	Identifies limited concepts; some inaccuracies	Unable to identify key concepts correctly
Concept Mapping Structure	25%	Constructs a clear, logical, and well-organized concept map with proper hierarchy and connections	Concept map is mostly clear with minor structural issues	Concept map lacks clarity, organization, or proper flow	No clear structure or incorrect mapping
Linking & Relationships	20%	Clearly establishes correct relationships between layers, functions, and processes	Relationships are mostly correct with minor errors	Limited or partially correct relationships	Incorrect or missing relationships
Application & Analysis	20%	Effectively applies concepts to explain processes (e.g., encapsulation, error control) with strong reasoning	The application is correct but lacks depth in analysis	Basic application with weak explanation	Unable to apply concepts correctly
Explanation & Clarity	15%	Provides a clear, concise, and well-structured explanation supporting the concept map	Explanation is understandable with minor gaps	Explanation is unclear or incomplete	No clear or meaningful explanation

Q1. Missing Layers in the OSI Concept Map

Concept map: Application → Presentation → Session → Transport → Network → Data Link → Physical

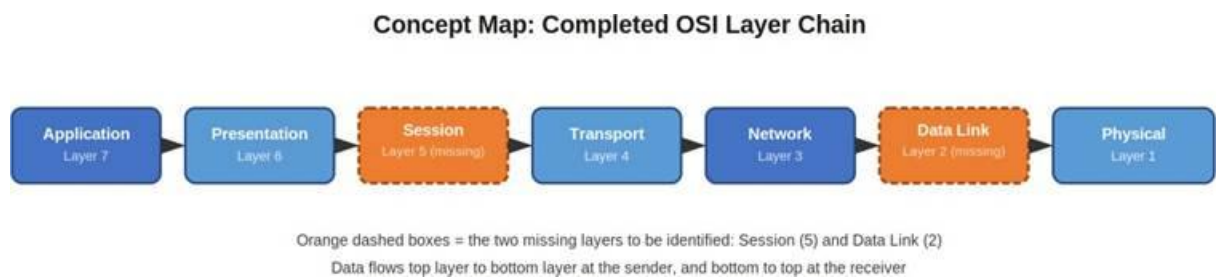


Figure 1: Completed seven-layer OSI concept map with the missing layers filled in

Analysis:

- Session Layer (missing, between Presentation and Transport): establishes, manages, and terminates the dialogue (session) between two communicating applications. It provides synchronization points, allowing communication to resume without restarting entirely if it is interrupted — essential for reliable, uninterrupted data exchange.
- Data Link Layer (missing, between Network and Physical): organizes bits from the Physical layer into frames, adds MAC addressing, and performs error detection (via CRC) for each hop across the local network. This ensures data is delivered correctly between directly connected devices.

Together, these two layers close the gap between application-level dialogue control and physical transmission. Without the Session layer, applications would have no way to manage ongoing conversations; without the Data Link layer, raw bits could not be organized or checked for errors before reaching the Physical medium. Their presence is what allows the encapsulation chain to support truly reliable, end-to-end communication.

Q2. Data Units Linked to OSI Layers

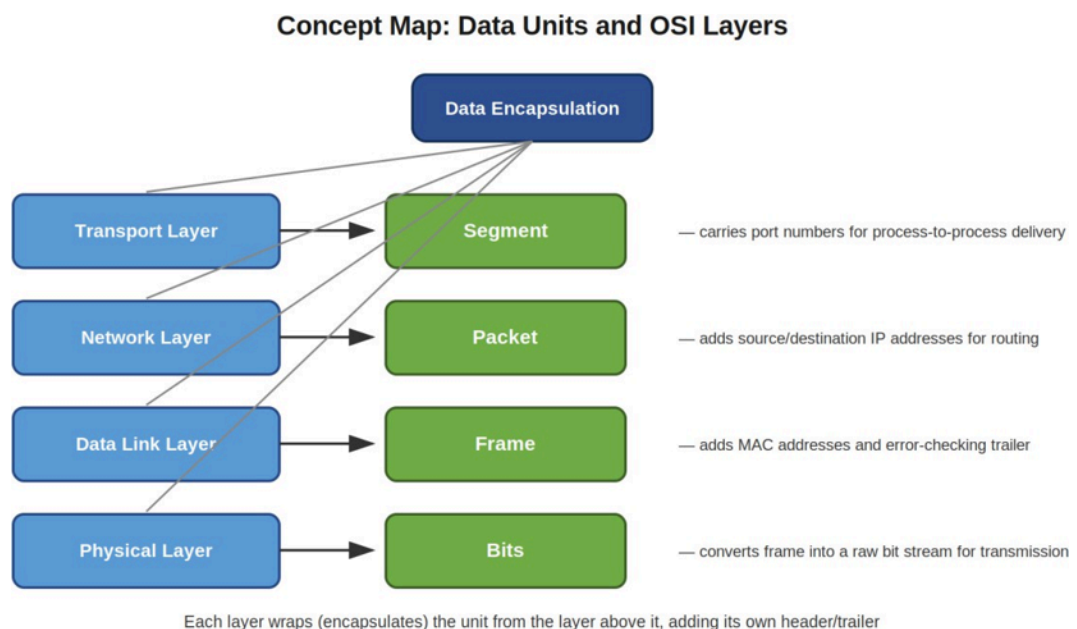


Figure 2: Concept map linking Segment, Packet, Frame, and Bits to their respective layers

Analysis:

- Transport Layer → Segment: application data is divided into segments, with port numbers added so the right process on the destination host receives it.
- Network Layer → Packet: each segment is encapsulated into a packet with source and destination IP addresses added, enabling routing across networks.
- Data Link Layer → Frame: each packet becomes a frame with MAC addresses and an error-checking trailer added, enabling delivery across a single physical link.

- Physical Layer → Bits: the frame is converted into a raw stream of bits (electrical, optical, or radio signals) for actual transmission over the medium.

This step-by-step transformation, known as encapsulation, is what makes reliable transmission possible: each layer adds exactly the control information it needs, without the layer above needing to know how the layer below achieves delivery. At the receiving end, the reverse process (de-encapsulation) strips each header/trailer in order, reconstructing the original data for the receiving application.

Q3. MAC and IP Addressing for Local and Global Delivery

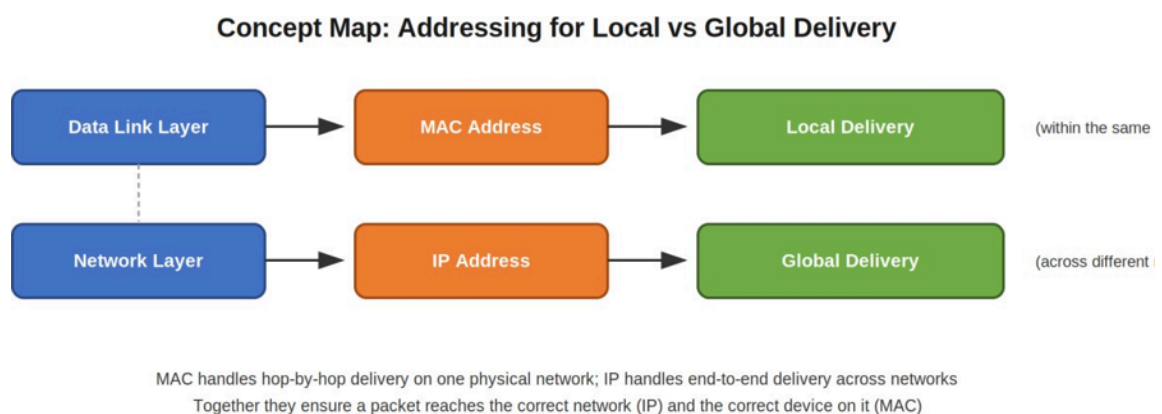


Figure 3: Concept map showing how MAC and IP addresses map to local and global delivery

Analysis:

- Data Link → MAC Address → Local Delivery: the MAC address is a physical, hardware-level address unique to a network interface. It is used only within a single local network (LAN) segment to deliver frames from one device directly to another on the same physical medium.
- Network → IP Address → Global Delivery: the IP address is a logical address that identifies both the network and the host. It allows packets to be routed across multiple interconnected networks, all the way to a destination anywhere on the internet.

These two addressing schemes work together in a hierarchy: IP addressing gets a packet to the correct network anywhere in the world (global delivery), while MAC addressing takes over for the final hop, delivering it to the exact device on that local network (local delivery). This division of responsibility — one address for the journey across networks and another for the last step within a network — is what allows data to travel reliably from source to destination even when many networks lie in between.

Q4. Error Control Across the Data Link and Transport Layers

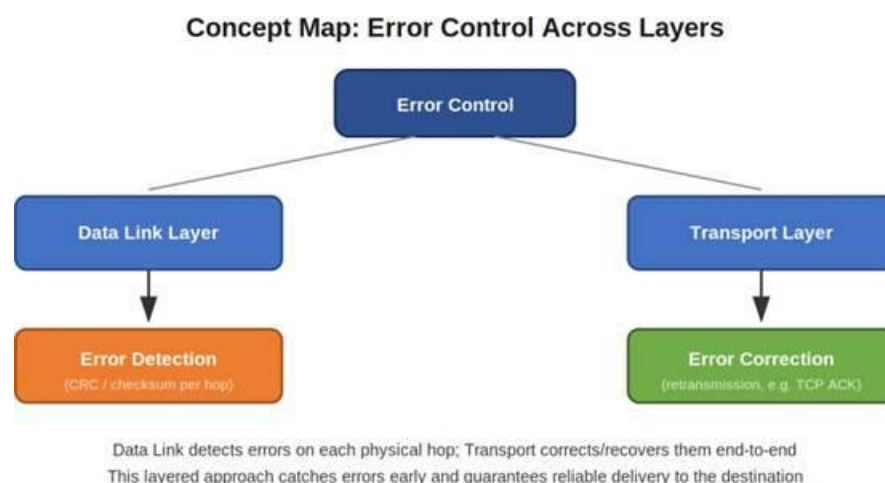


Figure 4: Concept map of complementary error-control responsibilities across layers

Analysis:

- Data Link Layer → Error Detection: uses techniques such as CRC (Cyclic Redundancy Check) or checksums to detect if bits were corrupted during transmission over a single physical link. It flags errors early, hop by hop.
- Transport Layer → Error Correction: uses acknowledgements, sequence numbers, and retransmission (e.g., in TCP) to recover from lost or corrupted segments, guaranteeing correct delivery end-to-end.

The interaction between these two layers creates a layered defense against errors: the Data Link layer catches problems close to where they occur, preventing obviously corrupted frames from propagating further, while the Transport layer provides an end-to-end guarantee that any data that still goes missing or arrives damaged is detected and retransmitted. This combination greatly improves overall reliability, since no single layer has to carry the entire burden of ensuring error-free communication.

Q5. Web Browsing Modeled Through the OSI Layers

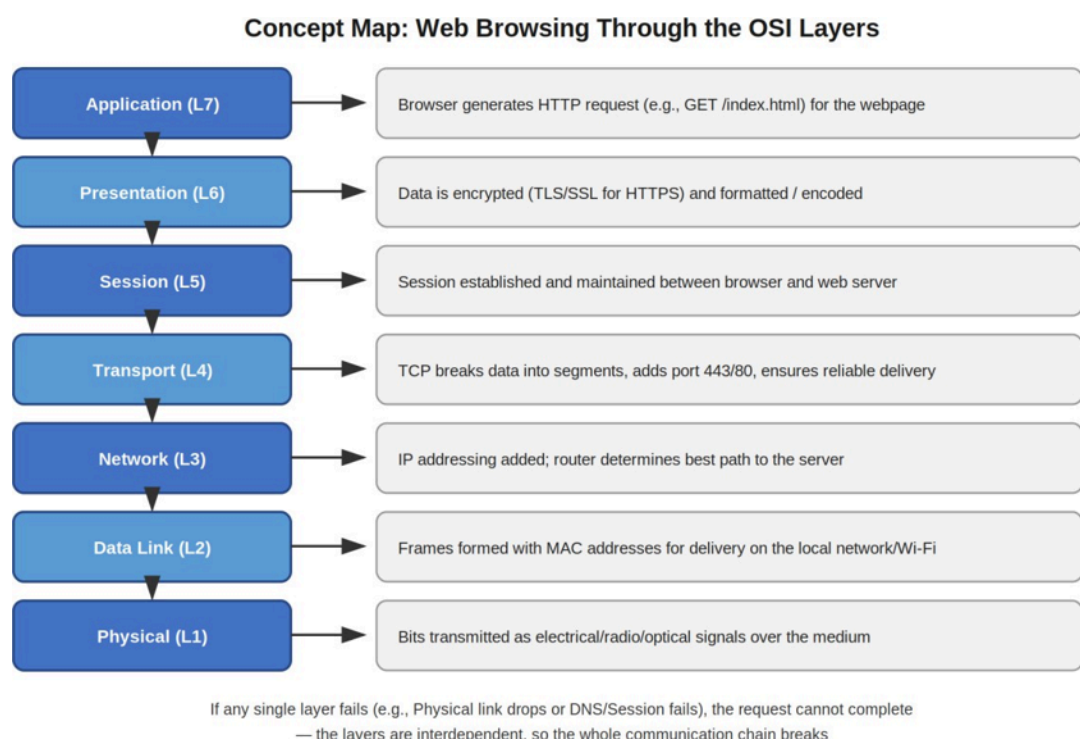


Figure 5: Concept map tracing a web browsing request through all seven OSI layers

Analysis:

When a user opens a webpage, each OSI layer contributes a specific function: the Application layer generates the HTTP(S) request; the Presentation layer encrypts and formats the data (TLS); the Session layer maintains the dialogue with the web server; the Transport layer (TCP) breaks data into segments and ensures reliable delivery; the Network layer (IP) determines the routing path; the Data Link layer frames the data with MAC addressing for the local network; and the Physical layer transmits the actual bits over the medium (Wi-Fi, cable, fiber, etc.).

Because each layer depends on the one below it, a failure at any single layer breaks the entire chain. For example, if the Physical layer loses signal (cable unplugged or Wi-Fi out of range), no frames can be sent, so the Network layer cannot route packets, the Transport layer cannot confirm delivery, and the Application layer never receives the webpage — the browser simply times out. This illustrates why OSI layers are interdependent: reliable web browsing requires every layer to perform its function correctly, in sequence.

Q6. Troubleshooting a Network Issue Using the Concept Map

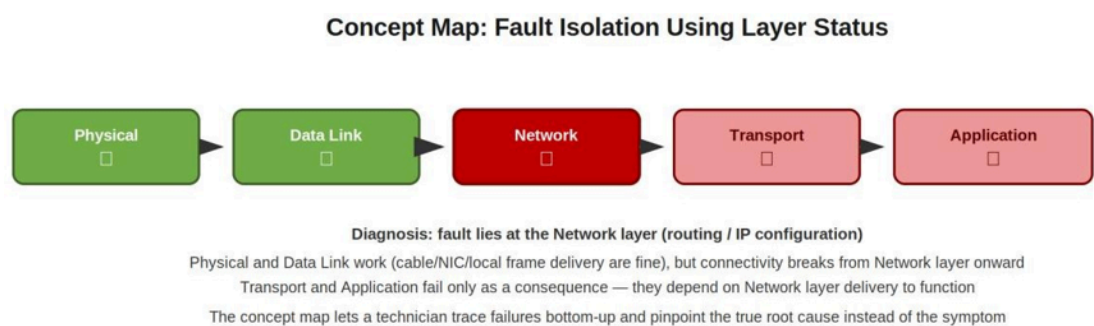


Figure 6: Layer-by-layer status used to isolate the point of failure

Analysis:

The concept map shows Physical and Data Link layers functioning correctly (✓), while Network, Transport, and Application layers are failing (✗). Since Transport and Application both depend on the Network layer to deliver packets, and both layers below Network are healthy, the fault can be isolated to the Network layer itself — most likely an IP addressing, subnet, gateway, or routing misconfiguration.

How the concept map helps in troubleshooting:

- It visually separates working layers from failing ones, so a technician doesn't need to guess where to start looking.
- Because OSI layers are dependent on the ones below them, the map lets the technician quickly recognize that Transport and Application failures here are consequences, not causes.
- It directs troubleshooting effort straight to the Network layer (checking IP configuration, routing tables, or gateway reachability) instead of wasting time on the physical cabling or application software, which are already confirmed to be working.

This bottom-up, layer-by-layer approach is exactly why the OSI model is valued in real-world network diagnostics: it turns a vague symptom ("the internet isn't working") into a precise, testable hypothesis about which layer has failed.

— End of Submission —